SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

24 May 2022 · Shift 2

83 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 17 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

English Language 21 questions

Q.2

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. One's family plays a very "major role to continue the trends" and age-old traditions.

(A) passive role in making the trends
(B) futile part in making trends
(C) significant role in enduring the trends
(D) docile part in enduring trends

Q.3

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the following sentence. I felt terribly "jaded" after working all weekend.

(A) glutted
(B) refreshed
(C) spent
(D) vigorous

Q.4

Select the correctly spelt word to fill in the blank. The people from sub-continent are very _____.

(A) superstitios
(B) superstitious
(C) supersticious
(D) supersctitious

Q.6

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. A trip to the village temple was made by Bhavani yesterday.

(A) Bhavani was going to make a trip to the temple yesterday.
(B) Bhavani made a trip to the village temple yesterday.
(C) Bhavani tripped to the village temple yesterday.
(D) Bhavani is going to make a trip to the temple today.

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. He dreams "big" than his friends.

(A) bigger
(B) more big
(C) biggest
(D) most big

Q.8

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Unable to speak distinctly or express oneself clearly

(A) Inane
(B) Inapt
(C) Inarch
(D) Inarticulate

Q.9

Select the most appropriate synonym of the word given in the brackets to fill in the blank. The university team won the match in the end with a _____ (cunning) move.

(A) brilliant
(B) slick
(C) random
(D) quick

Q.10

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Gear up for

(A) Start off
(B) Pass into
(C) Get ready for
(D) Put on

Q.11

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. The first time that I was seated behind a curtain in a dining car, I felt as if the curtain had been dropped on my selfhood and could never adjust to the separate waiting rooms, separate eating places, separate rest rooms, partly because the separate was always unequal, and partly because the very idea of separation did something to my sense of dignity and self-respect. B. One Sunday, we went to church in Simsbury, and we were the only Negroes there and on Sunday mornings I was the religious leader and spoke on any text I wanted to 107 boys. C. Just before going to college I went to Simsbury, Connecticut, and worked for a whole summer on a tobacco farm to earn a little school money to supplement what my parents were doing. D. After that summer in Connecticut, it was a bitter feeling going back to segregation and it was hard to understand why I could ride wherever I pleased on the train from New York to Washington and then had to change to a Jim Crow car at the nation's capital in order to continue the trip to Atlanta.

(A) ADBC
(B) BCDA
(C) CBDA
(D) CDBA

Q.12

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Call upon

(A) To adjust
(B) To stop
(C) To follow
(D) To order

Q.13

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. The boy kicked the ball high into the air.

(A) The ball will be kicked high into the air by the boy.
(B) The ball was kicked high into the air by the boy.
(C) The boy kicks the ball high into the air.
(D) The boy had kicked the ball high into the air.

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. A wise king's wisdom _____the land like the sun.

(A) illuminates
(B) darkens
(C) dims
(D) spreads

Q.15

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A small organised dissenting group within a larger one

(A) Band
(B) Set
(C) Faction
(D) Cluster

Q.16

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Abundant

(A) Abysmal
(B) Ephemeral
(C) Scarce
(D) Plentiful

Q.17

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. Kiara will sign all the documents tomorrow.

(A) Kiara was to be signed by tomorrow for all the documents.
(B) Tomorrow Kiara will be signed by all the documents.
(C) All the documents will be signed by Kiara tomorrow.
(D) Kiara would have been signed tomorrow by all the documents.

Q.19

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Efficient
(B) Layer
(C) Committee
(D) Feeld

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Novelists when they write novels tend to take an almost god-like attitude (1) _____ their subject, pretending to a total comprehension of the story, a man's life, (2) _____ they can therefore recount as God Himself might, nothing standing between them and the naked truth, the entire story meaningful in (3) _____ detail. I am as little able to do this as the novelist is, even though my story is more important to me than any novelist's is to him – for this is my story; it is the story of a man, not of an invented, or possible, or idealised or otherwise (4) _____ figure, but of a unique (5) _____ of flesh and blood.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) despite
(B) under
(C) through
(D) towards

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Novelists when they write novels tend to take an almost god-like attitude (1) _____ their subject, pretending to a total comprehension of the story, a man's life, (2) _____ they can therefore recount as God Himself might, nothing standing between them and the naked truth, the entire story meaningful in (3) _____ detail. I am as little able to do this as the novelist is, even though my story is more important to me than any novelist's is to him – for this is my story; it is the story of a man, not of an invented, or possible, or idealised or otherwise (4) _____ figure, but of a unique (5) _____ of flesh and blood.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) whose
(B) whom
(C) who
(D) which

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Novelists when they write novels tend to take an almost god-like attitude (1) _____ their subject, pretending to a total comprehension of the story, a man's life, (2) _____ they can therefore recount as God Himself might, nothing standing between them and the naked truth, the entire story meaningful in (3) _____ detail. I am as little able to do this as the novelist is, even though my story is more important to me than any novelist's is to him – for this is my story; it is the story of a man, not of an invented, or possible, or idealised or otherwise (4) _____ figure, but of a unique (5) _____ of flesh and blood.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) every
(B) self
(C) last
(D) present

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Novelists when they write novels tend to take an almost god-like attitude (1) _____ their subject, pretending to a total comprehension of the story, a man's life, (2) _____ they can therefore recount as God Himself might, nothing standing between them and the naked truth, the entire story meaningful in (3) _____ detail. I am as little able to do this as the novelist is, even though my story is more important to me than any novelist's is to him – for this is my story; it is the story of a man, not of an invented, or possible, or idealised or otherwise (4) _____ figure, but of a unique (5) _____ of flesh and blood.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) callous
(B) absent
(C) ordinary
(D) profuse

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Novelists when they write novels tend to take an almost god-like attitude (1) _____ their subject, pretending to a total comprehension of the story, a man's life, (2) _____ they can therefore recount as God Himself might, nothing standing between them and the naked truth, the entire story meaningful in (3) _____ detail. I am as little able to do this as the novelist is, even though my story is more important to me than any novelist's is to him – for this is my story; it is the story of a man, not of an invented, or possible, or idealised or otherwise (4) _____ figure, but of a unique (5) _____ of flesh and blood.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) organism
(B) being
(C) cripple
(D) stance

General Intelligence 18 questions

Q.1

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 25*5*10*2*8*60

(A) ÷,×,+,−, =
(B) ÷,×,−,+, =
(C) ×, ÷,−,+, =
(D) −,+,÷,×,=

Q.2

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation.
42*4*69*3*29*60*5

(A) +,=,−,×,÷,−
(B) ×,−,=, ×,+,÷
(C) +,÷,=,−,×,+
(D) −,=,×,+,×,÷

Q.3

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series?
286,303,320,371,422,507,?

(A) 626
(B) 592
(C) 602
(D) 582

Q.4

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1.Dish 2.Disease 3.Discuss 4.Disjoin 5.Disgrace

(A) 2, 3, 1, 5, 4
(B) 2, 3, 5, 1, 4
(C) 3, 2, 5, 1, 4
(D) 3, 2, 1, 5, 4

Q.6

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. DETAILS : TEDASLI :: EMPATHY : PMEAYHT :: FORMULA : ?

(A) ROFMALU
(B) RFMALUO
(C) RFOMALU
(D) ALUMROF

Q.7

In a certain code language, 'WORTH' is written as 'ZRRWK' and ‘TRACK’ is written as ‘WUAFN’. How will 'FAITH' be written in that language?

(A) JDIWK
(B) HDIWL
(C) KDIVK
(D) IDIWK

Q.8

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 52 : 5 :: 100 : 7 :: 164 : ?

(A) 7
(B) 8
(C) 11
(D) 9

Q.10

Select the option that represents the letters that, when placed from left to right in the blanks, will complete the letter series. S _ O Z Q T L O _ Q U _ O _ Q V L O Z _

(A) L Z L Z Q
(B) Z L Z Q L
(C) Z L Q L Z
(D) L Z Q Z L

Q.12

In a certain code language, 'SAMPLE' is written as ‘RYJLGY’ and ‘MAPLE’ is written as ’LYMHZ’.How will 'PEOPLE' be written in that language?

(A) OCLLGL
(B) GCLLGY
(C) OBGLGY
(D) OCLLGY

Q.13

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 91*15*5*18*37

(A) =,÷,×,+

(B) +,=,×,−

(C) +,−,=,×

(D) −,=,+,−

Q.14

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 37*3*21*79*18*4*19

(A) −,−,=,×,+,÷

(B) ×,+,−,=, ×, −

(C) +,×, −,=,+,−

(D) =,−,×,+,−,×

Q.15

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 25*5*10*2*8*44

(A) ÷,×,+,−, =

(B) ×, ÷,−,+, =

(C) ÷,×,−,+, =

(D) −,+,÷,×,=

Q.16

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? DRBZ, ABKX, ?, UVCT, RFLR

(A) YDMC

(B) YDBE

(C) XUIV

(D) XLTV

Q.17

The second number in the given number-pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number-pairs EXCEPT one. Find that odd number-pair.

(A) 169 : 14

(B) 225 : 18

(C) 196 : 17

(D) 256 : 19

Q.18

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 16*4*8*10*2*24

(A) ÷,×,−,+, =

(B) −,÷,+,×, =

(C) ×, ÷,−,+, =

(D) ÷,+,×,−, =

Q.19

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1.Negotiation 2.Negate 3.Networking 4.Negligible 5.Newspaper

(A) 4,2,1,3,5

(B) 2,4,1,3,5

(C) 2,1,4,3,5

(D) 4,1,2,3,5

Q.21

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and balance the given equation. 57*35*44*11*13*74

(A) +,−, ×,÷, =

(B) +, −, ÷,×, =

(C) ×, +, ÷,−, =

(D) −,+,÷,×, =

Q.25

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. AMOUNT : MOUNT :: BRIDGE : RIDGE :: BRIGHT : ?

(A) RIGHT
(B) SIGHT
(C) KIGHT
(D) NIGHT

Quantitative Aptitude 20 questions

Q.2

A trader marks his goods at 45% above the cost price. He offers a discount of 21% to his customers. What is his percentage profit (rounded off to the nearest integer)?

(A) 12%
(B) 18%
(C) 14%
(D) 15%

Q.3

Which of the following numbers is divisible by 7?

(A) 3739
(B) 3661
(C) 3659
(D) 3915

Q.4

A new mobile is introduced into the market and is marked at 25% above its original cost price. What discount should be given on the marked price to gain a profit of 20%?

(A) 2.50%
(B) 5%
(C) 4%
(D) 10%

Q.5

If $2a + b = 10$, $2ab = 9$, and $2a > b$, then find the value of $2a - b$.

(A) 12
(B) 6
(C) 8
(D) 10

Q.6

Find the mean proportion of 3 and 27.

(A) 5
(B) 10
(C) 6
(D) 9

Q.7

Shovik purchases two types of sugar: the first type at Rs.45 per kg and the second type at Rs.80 per kg. In what ratio should Shovik blend the first type of sugar with the second type so that, by selling each kg of the blended sugar at Rs.72 per kg, he makes a profit of 20%?

(A) 4 : 3
(B) 5 : 4
(C) 3 : 4
(D) 3 : 2

Q.8

Find the volume of a hemisphere whose diameter is 6 cm. (Take $\pi=22/7$)

(A) 144π cm^3
(B) 48π cm^3
(C) 18π cm^3
(D) 36π cm^3

Q.9

The value of $11 \div [1 + 1 \div \{1 + 1 \div (1 + 1 \div 3)\}]$ is:

(A) 1
(B) 7
(C) 9
(D) 11

Q.10

If $a + b = 12$ and $ab = 35$, find the value of $a^4 + b^4 - 10^3$?

(A) 2226 **(B)** 2026

(C) 2126 **(D)** 1226

Q.13

Inside a triangle ABC, a straight line parallel to BC intersects AB and AC at the points P and Q, respectively. If AB = 6PB, then PQ : BC is _____.

(A) 2 : 6 **(B)** 3 : 4

(C) 5 : 4 **(D)** 5 : 6

Q.16

In a test, the average score of 50 students is 66. Out of the total students, 40% are girls and the rest are boys. The average score of the boys is 20% less than that of the girls. What is the average score of the girls?

(A) 70 **(B)** 80

(C) 75 **(D)** 65

Q.17

If base radius and height of a cylinder are 4 cm and 5 cm, respectively, then find the curved surface area of the cylinder [use $\pi = 3.14$].

(A) 125.6 cm^2 **(B)** 138 cm^2

(C) 129.8 cm^2 **(D)** 119.6 cm^2

Q.18

Sin (–A) = ?

(A) Cos A **(B)** –Cos A

(C) –Sin A **(D)** Sin A

Q.19

The population of a village is 9,000. If the annual birth rate is 12.5% and the annual death rate is 2.5%, calculate the population after three years.

(A) 12256 **(B)** 11979

(C) 10959 **(D)** 10755

Q.20

In an election between two candidates, Ravi gets 65% of total valid votes. If total votes were 6000, what is the number of valid votes that the other candidate Sushil gets, if 25% of total votes were invalid?

(A) 1775 **(B)** 1625

(C) 1575 **(D)** 1525

Q.21

Find the average of the following data : 1, 2, 3, 5, 17, 21 and 28

(A) 13 **(B)** 11

(C) 9 **(D)** 12

Q.22

A and B together can do a piece of work in 12 days, while A alone can complete the same work in 18 days. How long will B alone take to complete the work?

(A) 6 days **(B)** 12 days

(C) 24 days **(D)** 36 days

Q.23

A man can row 5 km/h in still water. If the speed of the current is 2.5 km/h, it takes 4 hours more in upstream than in the downstream for the same distance. The distance is:

(A) 10.5 km
(B) 15 km
(C) 7.5 km
(D) 12 km

Q.24

A man P purchased a land for ₹4,32,000 on the outskirts of a city. Due to some reason, its value depreciated at 25% per annum and he sold it to Q after 2 years. At this time, the city expanded and new projects of infrastructures started coming up. As a result of the expansion, there was an appreciation of real estate prices at the rate of 50%. What would be the value (in ₹) of the land after 2 years, from the time Q bought the land from P?

(A) ₹5,46,750
(B) ₹5,57,450
(C) ₹5,76,450
(D) ₹6,05,070

Q.25

A shopkeeper marks up his goods by 30% and then gives a discount of 10% on the marked price. Apart from this, he uses a faulty balance which reads 1 kg for 870 g. What is his net profit percentage?

(A) 38.42%
(B) 34.84%
(C) 34.48%
(D) 38.24%

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

Dr. Sunanda Nair is recognised as a _____ performer, teacher, and proponent.

(A) Mohiniyattam
(B) Kathak
(C) Kuchipudi
(D) Kathakali

Q.2

Which of the following books is NOT written by Arundhati Roy?

(A) Capitalism
(B) Private Life of An Indian Prince
(C) The God of Small Things
(D) An Ordinary Person's Guide to Empire

Q.3

Which of the following has launched the 'DBT-Star College Mentorship Programme' in November 2021?

(A) Ministry of Science and Technology
(B) Ministry of Tourism
(C) Ministry of Heavy Industries and Public Enterprises
(D) Ministry of Shipping

Q.4

Isopentane, also called _____, is a branched-chain saturated hydrocarbon with the chemical formula C_5H_{12}.

(A) dimethylbutane
(B) isobutane
(C) 2-methylbutane
(D) butadiene

Q.5

Which of the following countries will jointly organise the FIH Women's Hockey World Cup from 1 to 17 July 2022?

(A) Spain and Germany
(B) Spain and Netherlands
(C) India and Sri Lanka
(D) India and Pakistan

Q.6
Who among the following won Arjuna Award 2021 in Kabaddi discipline?

(A) Ajay Thakur
(B) Tejaswini Bai V
(C) Sandeep Narwal
(D) Jasvir Singh

Q.7
Padma Shri awardee Gopal Prasad Dubey was awarded for his contribution to which of the following dances?

(A) Sattriya
(B) Panthi
(C) Chhau
(D) Mohiniyattam

Q.8
Where is sodium located on the periodic table?

(A) Bottom of the table
(B) Top period
(C) On the right side
(D) On the left side

Q.9
Recently, some mail channels have been introduced to facilitate quick delivery of mail in large towns and cities in India. Which of the following is NOT a part of these mail channels?

(A) State Channel
(B) Rajdhani Channel
(C) Metro Channel
(D) Green Channel

Q.10
Who is the first Indian musician to win the Oscar award for Best Original Score?

(A) Bhanu Athaiya
(B) Resul Pookutty
(C) Mehboob Khan
(D) A.R. Rahman

Q.12
What is the position of non-metals in the periodic table?

(A) Bottom of the table
(B) On the right side
(C) On the left side
(D) Top period

Q.13
Which of the following is the youngest percussionist to be awarded Padma Shri and Padma Bhushan awards by the Government of India?

(A) T H Vinakram
(B) Sivamani
(C) Sarvar Sabri
(D) Zakir Hussain

Q.14
Which cell theory proved that the quasi-fluid nature of lipid enables lateral movement of proteins within the overall bilayer?

(A) Cell theory
(B) Fluid mosaic model
(C) Model of Golgi bodies
(D) Vacuole theory

Q.15
Identify the correct statement in relation toampere.

(A) One ampere is constituted by the flow of one coulomb of charge per minute
(B) One ampere is constituted by the flow of two coulomb of charge per second
(C) One ampere is constituted by the flow of one coulomb of charge per second
(D) One ampere is constituted by the flow of half coulomb of charge per second

Q.16
In the absence of the Speaker and the Deputy Speaker of Lok Sabha, who presides the joint sitting of the two houses of Parliament?

(A) Chairman of Rajya Sabha
(B) Any senior member of Rajya Sabha
(C) Deputy Chairman of Rajya Sabha
(D) Any senior member of Lok Sabha

Q.17
Shamshad begum, one of the first women to sing playback for Hindi movies, was conferred with the prestigious OP Nayyar Award for her contribution to Hindi film Music in the year _____.

(A) 2001
(B) 2009
(C) 2012
(D) 2005

Q.18
Who among the following Indian classical musicians was the very first to be presented with the Bharat Ratna, India's highest civilian honour?

(A) Madurai Shanmukhavadivu Subbulakshmi
(B) Bismillah Khan
(C) Lata Mangeshkar
(D) Ravi Shankar

Q.19
The Health Minister relaunched the intensified version 4.0 of the largest global inoculation drive in February 2022. What is the name of this Mission which covers crores of pregnant women and children?

(A) Mission Arogya
(B) Mission Shakti
(C) Mission Indradhanush
(D) Mission Suraksha

Q.20
Which of the following Marathi writers was the author of the autobiography 'Majya Jalmachi Chittarkatha'?

(A) Kusumagraj
(B) Sunita Deshpande
(C) Shivaji Sawant
(D) Shantabai Krushnaji Kamble

Q.21
Usually, which year of a series of years in an economic index is called the base year?

(A) First year
(B) Twentieth year
(C) Tenth year
(D) Last year

Q.22
Identify the terrestrial planet from among the following.

(A) Uranus
(B) Jupiter
(C) Mercury
(D) Neptune

Q.23
Meenakshi Srinivasan received the Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar 2011 for which of the following dance forms?

(A) Sattriya
(B) Mohiniyattam
(C) Kuchipudi
(D) Bharatanatyam

Q.24
When was the Sri Shanmukhananda National Eminence Award set up?

(A) 2001
(B) 2002
(C) 2000
(D) 2003

Q.25

'The God of Small Things', a winner of the 1997 Booker Prize, is the debut novel of which of the following Indian writers?

(A) Jhumpa Lahiri
(B) Kiran Desai
(C) Anita Desai
(D) Arundhati Roy

Answer key

English Language

Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**
Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**
Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**
Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(B)**			

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(D)**
Q.8 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**
Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.25 **(A)**

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(A)**
Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**
Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**
Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(C)**				

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(D)**

Explanations

English Language

Q.2 · Answer (C) significant role in enduring the trends

'Play a role in' takes a gerund ('in enduring'), not 'to continue', and 'very major' is awkward where 'very significant' is natural; 'enduring' is used loosely here, in the sense of keeping alive. 'Passive', 'futile' and 'docile' would reverse the sense of an important role.

Q.3 · Answer (B) refreshed

'Jaded' means tired out or dulled, here by too much work; its direct opposite is 'refreshed' (restored after tiredness), a closer fit than the more general 'vigorous' (strong, energetic). 'Spent' means much the same as 'jaded'.

Q.4 · Answer (B) superstitious

The correct spelling is 'superstitious'.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Bhavani made a trip to the village temple yesterday.

The agent, Bhavani, becomes the subject and 'was made' becomes the simple past 'made': 'Bhavani made a trip to the village temple yesterday.'

Q.7 · Answer (A) bigger

'Than' needs the comparative, and the one-syllable 'big' takes '-er': 'He dreams bigger than his friends.'

Q.8 · Answer (D) Inarticulate

'Inarticulate' means unable to speak distinctly or express oneself clearly; 'inane' means silly and 'inapt' unsuitable.

Q.9 · Answer (B) slick

'Slick' can mean clever and skilful in a crafty way, close to 'cunning'; 'brilliant', 'random' and 'quick' carry no sense of craft.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Get ready for

To 'gear up for' something is to get ready for it.

Q.11 · Answer (C) CBDA

C opens the story (a summer job in Simsbury before college), B tells of a Sunday there, D describes going back to segregation after that summer, and A gives the feeling of being seated behind a curtain: CBDA.

Q.12 · Answer (D) To order

To 'call upon' someone to do something is to ask or require it of them formally; of the options, only 'to order' carries that sense.

Q.13 · Answer (B) The ball was kicked high into the air by the boy.

The simple past 'kicked' becomes 'was kicked', with the object as subject: 'The ball was kicked high into the air by the boy.'

Q.14 · Answer (A) illuminates

Like the sun, wisdom 'illuminates' (lights up) the land; 'spreads' would need 'across' or 'over'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Faction

A faction is a small organised group, usually in dissent, within a larger one.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Plentiful

'Abundant' means existing in large quantities: 'plentiful'. 'Scarce' is its opposite.

Q.17 · Answer (C) All the documents will be signed by Kiara tomorrow.

'Will sign' becomes 'will be signed', with the object as subject: 'All the documents will be signed by Kiara tomorrow.'

Q.19 · Answer (D) Feeld
The correct spelling is 'field'.

Q.21 · Answer (D) towards
An attitude is taken 'towards' something: 'a god-like attitude towards their subject'.

Q.22 · Answer (D) which
'Which' refers back to 'the story, a man's life', a thing; 'who' and 'whom' are for people.

Q.23 · Answer (A) every
The novelists claim to understand the whole story, so it is meaningful in 'every' detail.

Q.24 · Answer (B) absent
'Invented, or possible, or idealised or otherwise absent': figures that are not really there, as against the real man of flesh and blood.

Q.25 · Answer (B) being
'A unique being of flesh and blood': a living person, as against an imagined figure.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (D) –,+,÷,×,=
25 – 5 + 10 ÷ 2 × 8 = 60: division and multiplication first, 10 ÷ 2 × 8 = 40, and 25 – 5 + 40 = 60.

Q.2 · Answer (B) ×,–,=, ×,+,÷
42 × 4 – 69 = 3 × 29 + 60 ÷ 5: the left side is 168 – 69 = 99 and the right side 87 + 12 = 99.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 592
The differences come in pairs: 17, 17 (17 × 1), 51, 51 (17 × 3), then 85, 85 (17 × 5). 507 + 85 = 592.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 3, 2, 5, 1, 4
After 'dis', the fourth letters c, e, g, h, j give the order: Discuss, Disease, Disgrace, Dish, Disjoin.

Q.6 · Answer (A) ROFMALU
The first three letters are reversed, the middle letter stays and the last three are reversed: DET A ILS → TED A SLI and EMP A THY → PME A YHT. So FOR M ULA → ROF M ALU: ROFMALU.

Q.7 · Answer (D) IDIWK
Every letter moves 3 places forward except the middle one, which stays: WORTH → ZRRWK and TRACK → WUAFN. So FAITH → I D I W K: IDIWK.

Q.8 · Answer (D) 9
The first number is twice the square of the second plus 2: $2 \times 5^2 + 2 = 52$ and $2 \times 7^2 + 2 = 100$. Likewise $2 \times 9^2 + 2 = 164$, so the answer is 9.

Q.10 · Answer (A) L Z L Z Q
With L, Z, L, Z, Q in the blanks the series reads SLOZQ TLOZQ ULOZQ VLOZQ: the first letter moves on one place and LOZQ repeats.

Q.12 · Answer (D) OCLLGY
The letters move back 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6 places in turn, wrapping round from A to Z: SAMPLE → RYJLGY and MAPLE → LYMHZ. So PEOPLE → O C L L G Y: OCLLGY.

Q.13 · Answer (A) =,÷,×,+
91 = 15 ÷ 5 × 18 + 37, since 15 ÷ 5 × 18 = 54 and 54 + 37 = 91.

Q.14 · Answer (B) ×,+,–,=, ×, –
37 × 3 + 21 – 79 = 18 × 4 – 19: the left side is 111 + 21 – 79 = 53 and the right side 72 – 19 = 53.

Q.15 · Answer (A) ÷,×,+,–, =
25 ÷ 5 × 10 + 2 – 8 = 44: 25 ÷ 5 × 10 = 50, and 50 + 2 – 8 = 44.

Q.16 · Answer (D) XLTV

First letters move back 3 (D, A, X, U, R), second letters forward 10 (R, B, L, V, F), third letters forward 9 (B, K, T, C, L) and fourth letters back 2 (Z, X, V, T, R), wrapping round the alphabet: XLTV.

Q.17 · Answer (A) 169 : 14

In the other pairs the second number is the square root of the first plus 3: 15 + 3 = 18, 14 + 3 = 17, 16 + 3 = 19. For 169 that gives 13 + 3 = 16, not 14.

Q.18 · Answer (A) ÷,×,−,+, =

16 ÷ 4 × 8 − 10 + 2 = 24: 16 ÷ 4 × 8 = 32, and 32 − 10 + 2 = 24.

Q.19 · Answer (B) 2,4,1,3,5

Negate, Negligible, Negotiation (after 'neg': a, l, o), then Networking and Newspaper ('net' before 'new'): 2, 4, 1, 3, 5.

Q.21 · Answer (D) −,+,÷,×, =

57 − 35 + 44 ÷ 11 × 13 = 74: 44 ÷ 11 × 13 = 52, and 57 − 35 + 52 = 74.

Q.25 · Answer (A) RIGHT

The second word is the first without its first letter: AMOUNT → MOUNT and BRIDGE → RIDGE, so BRIGHT → RIGHT.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 · Answer (D) 15%

Selling price = 1.45 × 0.79 = 1.1455 times the cost: a profit of 14.55%, or 15% to the nearest integer.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 3661

3661 = 7 × 523. The others leave remainders: 3739 = 7 × 534 + 1, 3659 = 7 × 522 + 5 and 3915 = 7 × 559 + 2.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 4%

Take the cost as 100: the marked price is 125 and the selling price must be 120. Discount = 5/125 × 100 = 4%.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 8

$(2a - b)^2 = (2a + b)^2 - 4 \times 2a \times b = 100 - 4 \times 9 = 64$. As $2a > b$, $2a - b = 8$.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 9

The mean proportional of a and b is $\sqrt{(ab)} = \sqrt{(3 \times 27)} = \sqrt{81} = 9$.

Q.7 · Answer (A) 4 : 3

Selling at ₹72 for a 20% profit means the blend costs 72/1.2 = ₹60 a kg. By alligation, (80 − 60) : (60 − 45) = 20 : 15 = 4 : 3.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 18π cm³

The radius is 3 cm: volume = $(2/3)\pi r^3 = (2/3)\pi \times 27 = 18\pi$ cm³.

Q.9 · Answer (B) 7

Innermost first: 1 + 1 ÷ 3 = 4/3; 1 + 1 ÷ 4/3 = 7/4; 1 + 1 ÷ 7/4 = 11/7; and 11 ÷ 11/7 = 7.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 2026

$a^2 + b^2 = 12^2 - 2 \times 35 = 74$, so $a^4 + b^4 = 74^2 - 2 \times 35^2 = 5{,}476 - 2{,}450 = 3{,}026$. Then $3{,}026 - 10^3 = 2{,}026$.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 5 : 6

PQ ∥ BC makes ΔAPQ similar to ΔABC. AB = 6PB gives AP = 5PB, so PQ : BC = AP : AB = 5 : 6.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 75

There are 20 girls and 30 boys. With the girls' average g, the boys' is 0.8g: 20g + 30 × 0.8g = 44g = 50 × 66 = 3,300, so g = 75.

Q.17 · Answer (A) 125.6 cm²

Curved surface area = $2\pi rh = 2 \times 3.14 \times 4 \times 5 = 125.6$ cm².

Q.18 · Answer (C) –Sin A
Sine is an odd function: sin(–A) = –sin A.

Q.19 · Answer (B) 11979
The population grows by 12.5% – 2.5% = 10% a year: 9,000 × 1.1^3 = 9,000 × 1.331 = 11,979.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 1575
Valid votes = 75% of 6,000 = 4,500. Sushil gets the other 35%: 0.35 × 4,500 = 1,575.

Q.21 · Answer (B) 11
The sum is 1 + 2 + 3 + 5 + 17 + 21 + 28 = 77, and 77 ÷ 7 = 11.

Q.22 · Answer (D) 36 days
B alone does 1/12 – 1/18 = 1/36 of the work a day, so B takes 36 days.

Q.23 · Answer (B) 15 km
Downstream the speed is 7.5 km/h and upstream 2.5 km/h. d/2.5 – d/7.5 = 4 gives 2d/7.5 = 4, so d = 15 km.

Q.24 · Answer (A) ₹5,46,750
Two years of 25% depreciation: 4,32,000 × 0.75 × 0.75 = ₹2,43,000. Taking the 50% as a yearly rate, two years of appreciation: 2,43,000 × 1.5 × 1.5 = ₹5,46,750.

Q.25 · Answer (C) 34.48%
He sells at 1.3 × 0.9 = 1.17 times the cost of 1 kg but hands over only 870 g, which costs 0.87 times as much. Profit = 1.17/0.87 – 1 = 0.3448, or 34.48%.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Mohiniyattam
Dr Sunanda Nair, the senior disciple of Kanak Rele, is a Mohiniyattam dancer and teacher who promotes the form from her school in Houston, USA.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Private Life of An Indian Prince
'Private Life of an Indian Prince' is a novel by Mulk Raj Anand. Arundhati Roy wrote 'The God of Small Things', 'An Ordinary Person's Guide to Empire' and 'Capitalism: A Ghost Story'.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Ministry of Science and Technology
The Department of Biotechnology (DBT), part of the Ministry of Science and Technology, launched the mentorship programme for its Star Colleges in November 2021.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 2-methylbutane
Isopentane is 2-methylbutane: a four-carbon butane chain with a methyl group on its second carbon, C_5H_{12} in all.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Spain and Netherlands
The 2022 FIH Women's Hockey World Cup was co-hosted by Spain (Terrassa) and the Netherlands (Amstelveen).

Q.6 · Answer (C) Sandeep Narwal
Kabaddi player Sandeep Narwal received the Arjuna Award in 2021.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Chhau
Gopal Prasad Dubey, a leading exponent of Seraikella Chhau from Jharkhand, received the Padma Shri in 2012.

Q.8 · Answer (D) On the left side
Sodium is an alkali metal in Group 1, the first column on the left side of the periodic table.

Q.9 · Answer (A) State Channel
NCERT lists six such mail channels: Rajdhani, Metro, Green, Business, Bulk Mail and Periodical. There is no 'State Channel'.

Q.10 · Answer (D) A.R. Rahman
A. R. Rahman won the Oscar for Best Original Score for 'Slumdog Millionaire' (2009). Bhanu Athaiya won hers for costume design and Resul Pookutty his for sound mixing.

Q.12 · Answer (B) On the right side
Apart from hydrogen, the non-metals are on the right side of the periodic table; metals take up the left and centre.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Zakir Hussain
SSC's key gives Zakir Hussain, the tabla player, who received the Padma Shri in 1988 and the Padma Bhushan in 2002; his biographies describe him as the youngest percussionist to receive them.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Fluid mosaic model
The fluid mosaic model of Singer and Nicolson (1972) holds that the quasi-fluid lipid bilayer lets proteins move sideways within it.

Q.15 · Answer (C) One ampere is constituted by the flow of one coulomb of charge per second
Current is charge per unit time (I = Q/t), so one ampere is a flow of one coulomb of charge per second.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Deputy Chairman of Rajya Sabha
A joint sitting is presided over by the Speaker, or in the Speaker's absence the Deputy Speaker; if both are absent, the Deputy Chairman of the Rajya Sabha presides. The Chairman of the Rajya Sabha does not.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 2009
Shamshad Begum received the O. P. Nayyar Award in 2009, the year she was also given the Padma Bhushan.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Madurai Shanmukhavadivu Subbulakshmi
M. S. Subbulakshmi received the Bharat Ratna in 1998, the first musician to be so honoured; Ravi Shankar followed in 1999, and Lata Mangeshkar and Bismillah Khan in 2001.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Mission Indradhanush
Mission Indradhanush immunises children and pregnant women against vaccine-preventable diseases; Intensified Mission Indradhanush 4.0 was launched in February 2022.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Shantabai Krushnaji Kamble
'Majya Jalmachi Chittarkatha' is the autobiography of Shantabai Krushnaji Kamble, a Dalit writer from Maharashtra.

Q.21 · Answer (A) First year
The base year is the reference year whose value is set at 100 and with which later years are compared; it is usually taken as the first year of the series.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Mercury
Mercury, Venus, Earth and Mars are the rocky, terrestrial planets; Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus and Neptune are giant planets.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Bharatanatyam
Meenakshi Srinivasan, a Chennai dancer trained by Alarmel Valli, received the Sangeet Natak Akademi's Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar for 2011 for Bharatanatyam.

Q.24 · Answer (B) 2002
SSC's key gives 2002, when Mumbai's Shanmukhananda Sabha set up the award to mark its golden jubilee.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Arundhati Roy
Arundhati Roy's first novel, 'The God of Small Things', won the Booker Prize in 1997.

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